Mercalli scale

5a

Guiseppe Mercalli (1850–1914) was an Italian seismologist. In 1902 he invented a scale for measuring earthquakes. Unlike the Richter scale, which relies upon readings from seismographs, Mercalli focused on the amount of damage caused by an earthquake as an indicator of the intensity or strength of the earthquake. The original Mercalli scale was updated in 1931 by Harvey Wood and Frank Neumann. Roman numerals are used to record the strength of the earthquake, where I is very low intensity and XII is total destruction.

Below are some earthquake pictures of different events. Cut out the diagrams and classify each one according to the Modified Mercalli scale on the following page. Paste them in the correct order in the space provided.

1



5



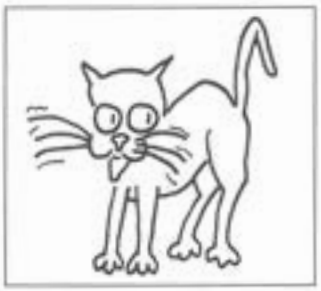
9



2



6



10



3



7



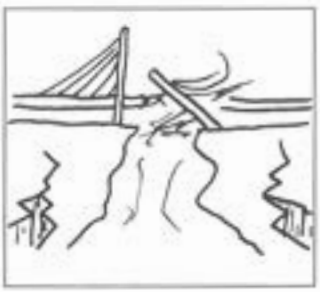
11



4



8



12



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Mercalli scale

5b

Modified Mercalli Scale

I Imperceptible. Not felt by the majority of people, but detected by seismographs. Animals tend to be a little uneasy.	
II Very weak. Some suspended objects may swing. People on upper floors of high buildings may feel it.	
III Weak. Felt by people indoors. Mostly mistaken as vibrations of a passing truck.	
IV Moderate. Felt by many more people indoors. Might wake people up, if at night. Windows, doors and crockery shake; walls tend to creak.	
V Fairly strong. Felt by nearly everyone, even people asleep. Objects may break and weak plaster cracks.	
VI Strong. Felt by everyone. Slight damage, such as chimneys falling. Heavy furniture moves.	

VII Very strong. People tend to run outside and may find it difficult to stand. Poorly built homes may have some damage. Causes waves on water.	
VIII Destructive. Most poorly built homes fall. Heavy furniture overturns.	
IX Very destructive. Most houses will have considerable damage. Roads may have minor cracks. Buried pipes may break.	
X Devastating. Many buildings destroyed. Railway tracks bend and ground cracks. Steep slopes may landslide and water splashes over from rivers and tanks.	
XI Catastrophic. Very few buildings left standing, bridges and underground pipes destroyed. Large ground cracks form.	
XII Major catastrophe. Total damage and destruction. Objects are thrown into the air.	

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